Notes

void data type indicates the compiler that the function does not return a value, or in a larger context void indicates that it holds nothing.

For Example:

void fun(void)

The above function prototype tells compiler that the function **fun()** neither receives values from calling program nor return a value to the calling program.

11.5.5 Accessing a function

The user-defined function should be called explicitly using its name and the required arguments to be passed. The compiler refers to the function prototype to check whether the function has been called correctly. If the argument type does not match exactly with the data type defined in the prototype, the compiler will perform type conversion, if possible. If type conversion is impossible, the compiler generates an error message.

Example :

1	display()	calling the function without a return value and without any argument
2	display (x, y)	calling the function without a return value and with arguments
3	x = display()	calling the function with a return value and without any argument
4	x = display (x, y)	calling the function with a return value and with arguments

11.5.5.1 Formal Parameters and Actual Parameters or Arguments

Arguments or parameters are the means to pass values from the calling function to the called function. The variables used in the function definition as parameters are known as formal parameters. The constants, variables or expressions used in the function call are known as actual parameters.

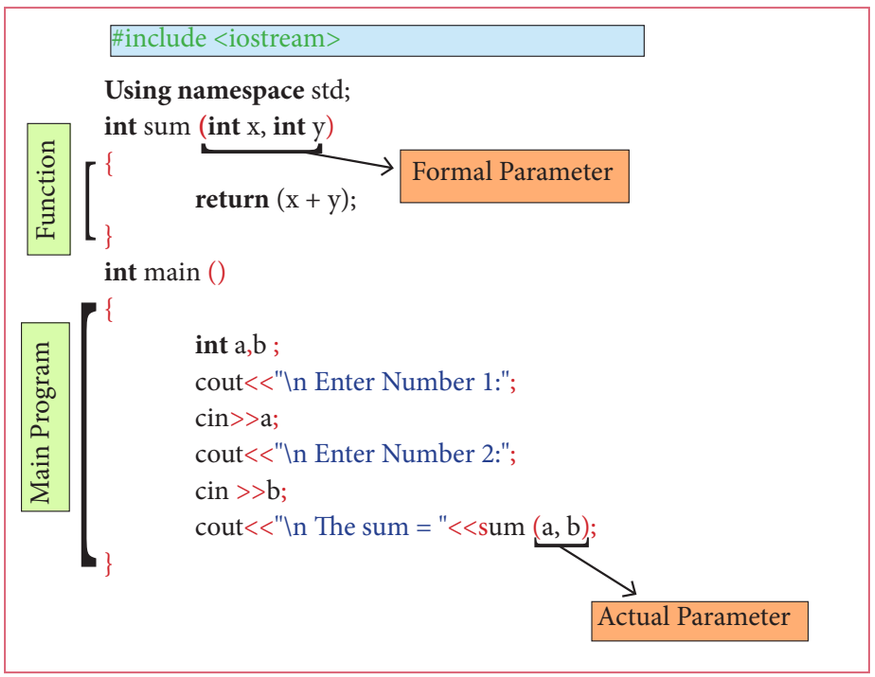

Figure 11.2 Formal and Actual Parameters

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